Vendor Selection & RFP Evaluation

WMS / Procurement System Replacement for a Mid-Size Manufacturing & Logistics Company

This is a self-directed simulation, built to practice full-lifecycle Business Analyst work end to end — current-state discovery through vendor selection to go-live sign-off. The company, stakeholders, and vendors are fictional; the artifacts, methodology, and decision-making are mine.

Overview

This case study follows a full business analysis lifecycle end to end — from current-state discovery through vendor selection to go-live sign-off — for a fictional mid-size manufacturing and logistics company retiring a discontinued, on-premise warehouse and procurement system. It's built to mirror a decision most BAs will face at some point in their career: how do you replace a system three departments quietly depend on, without a single stakeholder able to describe what 'good' looks like the same way twice?

Every artifact below is built on the same fictional company, project, and vendor shortlist, so the numbers, requirements, and recommendation trace consistently from one document to the next — the way they would need to on a real engagement.

Role Simulated

Lead Business Analyst — responsible for stakeholder discovery, requirements documentation, RFP authorship, vendor evaluation, UAT coordination, and rollout planning.

The Artifacts

#	Artifact	What It Demonstrates
1	Current-State Assessment	Stakeholder interviewing, synthesis, and pain-point analysis across 5 functions
2	Business Case & Cost-Benefit Analysis (Excel)	Financial modeling — NPV, payback period, build-vs-buy analysis with fully live formulas
3	RFP Document	Requirements elicitation translated into a structured, weighted vendor solicitation
4	Vendor Scorecard (Excel)	Objective, weighted vendor evaluation and a defensible written recommendation
5	BRD + Requirements Traceability Matrix (Excel)	Formal requirements documentation with end-to-end traceability to test cases
6	UAT Plan & Sign-Off	Test case design, defect management, and formal stakeholder acceptance
7	Change Management & Rollout Plan	Adoption risk, training design, and phased rollout planning — the part of BA work that isn't just documents

#	Artifact	What It Demonstrates
8	Current- vs. Future-State Process Diagram (PowerPoint)	Communicating a process visually, not just in prose — side-by-side warehouse and procurement flows, each step tied to a pain point
9	RACI Matrix + Risk Register (Excel)	Decision-rights clarity and proactive risk planning — the governance layer a vendor-selection project needs

Key Decision

Three vendors were shortlisted and evaluated on both cost and functional fit. The lowest-cost vendor looked strongest on paper (best NPV and shortest payback) until a mandatory-requirement gap — no native barcode/scanning support — was weighed against what the current-state interviews had identified as the single biggest driver of inventory inaccuracy. The mid-market vendor, not the cheapest or the most feature-rich option, came out ahead once cost and fit were weighed together — the kind of trade-off a scorecard is supposed to surface, rather than bury.

What I'd Do Differently

This project was built solo, so it's missing a few things a real engagement would have forced into the open. There's no live stakeholder conflict — real interviews rarely align this cleanly, and I'd expect at least one function to push back on another's priorities. The financial model runs on my own estimates rather than researched benchmarks or real vendor quotes, which is fine as a directional model but wouldn't survive a CFO's first question un-caveated. And the risk register (Document 9) was something I added only after stepping back and asking what a recruiter would expect to see in a 'selection to sign-off' scope — it should have been part of the first draft, not a follow-up fix.

Tools Used

Microsoft Word, Excel (formula-driven models, no hardcoded outputs), and standard BA artifacts — no code, no low-fidelity mockup tools — by design, to keep the focus on requirements and analysis rather than a technical build.